drilling machine and milling machine. It is also used to check the perpendicular of the surface either internally or externally. It is also used for marking tools like surface gauge. It is specified by its length, width and height.

2.15 TAP

A tap is a screw like tool which has threads like a bolt and three or four flutes cut across the thread. It is used to cut threads on inside of a hole as in a nut. The tap is used along with the wrench which holds the tap with it. The cutting edges are formed by the flutes on the thread. The lower end of the tap is somewhat tapered so that it can dig into the walls of the hole. The top of the tap has a square shank which helps it to be held by the wrench. Taps are made of either high speed steel or high carbon steel and hardened and tempered.

Taps are made in sets of three:

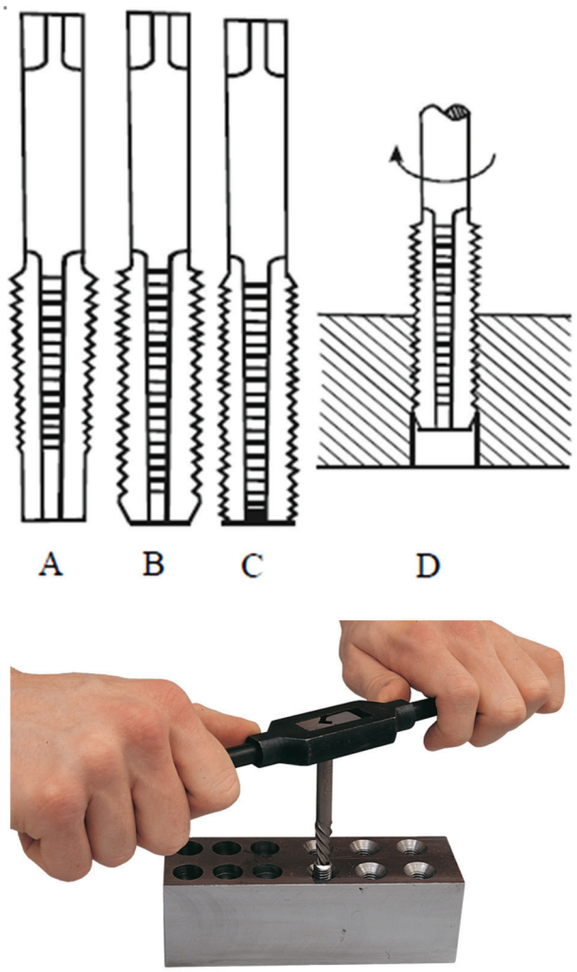
TAPER TAP



The taper tap has about six threads tapered. It allows the tap to dig into the hole easily to form threads gradually as the tap is moved clockwise and anti-clockwise while tapping. Oil is applied into the hole while tapping.

SECOND TAP

It is tapered back from the edge about three or four threads. This is used after the taper tap has been used to cut the thread as far as possible.



A. Taper tap B. Second tap C. Parallel tap D. Tapping

Types of Tap and Uses

PARALLEL TAP

It has threads for the whole of its length. It is used to finish the work prepared by the other two taps.

Important Points to be observed while tapping.

1. Taps should be used in order i.e., from taper tap to Parallel tap through the second tap.
2. It should be ensured whether the tap enters into the hole properly.

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